Hedge-fund proposal presented to Mark Scheffler

Art Ponomarev recalls presenting his hedge-fund proposal to Mark Scheffler. This folder records that part of Art's investment-research history.

Professional background

Mark Scheffler founded **The Appleton Group**, an independent registered investment adviser in Appleton, Wisconsin, in 2002. Johnson Financial Group's acquisition announcement identifies Scheffler as the founder and describes the firm's investment advisory business.

Johnson Financial Group's 2023 annual report confirms that The Appleton Group joined the firm in **September 2023**, with approximately **$210 million in assets under management** at the time.

Presentation record

Item	Details
Presenter	Art Ponomarev
Recipient	Mark Scheffler
Subject	Art's hedge-fund proposal
Presentation date	Not yet recorded
Source of this account	Art's recollection, documented on 7 November 2026

Correspondence context

Art supplied excerpts of his LinkedIn correspondence with Mark:

- **10 July 2011:** Art discussed his systematic-trading research, backtesting and modeling, and his earlier consulting for Christina Winch.
- **1 January 2012:** Art referred to a visit to Mark's Appleton office approximately two years earlier and described his continued algorithmic-trading research.
- **5 March 2025:** Art reintroduced himself, recalled their earlier investment-strategy discussions, and shared an update on his professional background.
- **15 March (year not displayed in the supplied excerpt):** Mark offered to look at Art's résumé if Art wished, while explaining that his focus had shifted toward a congressional campaign and that he had been away from hiring for some time.
- **16 March (year not displayed in the supplied excerpt):** Art explained that he was reconnecting and sharing his professional progress.

The January 2012 reference suggests an office visit around **2010**. The exact date of the hedge-fund proposal presentation remains unrecorded. The later exchange documents continued professional contact and Mark's willingness to review Art's résumé.

MACD and moving into cash

According to Art's recollection, Mark also discussed **Moving Average Convergence Divergence (MACD)** in connection with assessing market trends and moving into cash during market downturns. The specific signal thresholds, portfolio rules, and date of this discussion have not yet been documented.

Proposal materials

The original historical investment proposal is not included in the materials currently available for this repository. This document records the presentation; the original proposal text and slides can be added here if recovered.

For Art's current consulting services, see the Financial AI consulting proposal.

Return to the repository overview